AD R. D. FRANCISCUM VERDLER, SUMMUM MODERATOREM SODALITATIS SA- CERDOTUM A MISSIONE, TERTIO P L E N O SAECULO A CONDITA SODALITATE.

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D i l e c t e fili, s a l u t e m e t a p o s t o l i c a m b e n e d i c t i o n e m . — Q u a m V i n c e n t i u s a P a u l o , s t u d i o p r o v e h e n d a e a n i m a r u m salutis v e h e m e n t i s s i m o incensus, pauperibus evangelizandis condidit, ante annos trecentos, presbyterorum Congregationem, e a catholico n o m i n i h a c t a n t a d i u t u r n i t a t e temporis sic profuit, u t a e q u u m c o n s e n t a n e u m q u e p u t e m u s , saecularia sollemnia, q u a e i n d i e m s e p t i m u m d e c i m u m p r o x i m i m e n s i s incident, e t tibi e t quibus praees s o d a l i b u s e x h i s c e N o s t r a e gratulationis Litteris iucundiora exsi- s t e r e et christifidelibus o m n i b u s memorabiliora. Cur e n i m gratias provi- d e n t i s s i m o D e o n o n a g a m u s c o m m u n i t e r , qui t a m s a n c t u m a c t u o s u m q u e E c c l e s i a e s u a e dederit sacrorum a d m i n i s t r u m e t t a l e m v o b i s Conditorem P a t r e m q u e legiferum? Agrorum cultores, m a g n a m t u m p a r t e m neglectos, p r a e t e r e a q u e h o m i n e s vinculis m u l c a t o s v e l triremibus c o n d e m n a t o s , prae- d i c a t i o n e d i v i n i v e r b i e m e n d a r e a t q u e o m n i consolari caritatis officio; in egenis alendis s o s p i t a n d i s q u e s u m m a c o n t e n t i o n e elaborare; doctrinam g r a t i a m q u e Christi impertire infidelibus; clericos laicosque, per spiritualem r e c e s s u m c o m m e n t a t i o n i b u s rerum, a e t e r n a r u m e x c o l e n d o s , hospitio acci- pere; Seminaria dioecesana, paroecias, S a n c t u a r i a regunda ac procuranda assumere: e i u s m o d i q u i d e m m u n i a P a r e n s v e s t e r e t o b i v i t i p s e m e t , quan- t u m sibi licuit, e t v o b i s , e x i n s t i t u t o peculiari a c proprio, a d o b e u n d u m attribuit. Testis a u t e m historia est, V i n c e n t i o auctore a t q u e actore, q u o a d v i x i t , sodales v e s t r o s Galliae o m n i s provincias ad sacras e x p e d i t i o n e s in p o p u l o , praesertim rustico et agresti, h a b e n d a s continenter peragrasse, et non m o d o in. h a c A l m a U r b e et Genuae et A u g u s t a e T a u r i n o r u m d o m o s aperuisse, sed e t i a m in P o l o n i a m , H i b e r n i a m , S c o t i a m e t v e l in B a r b a r i a m , q u a m v o c a b a n t , i n i n s u l a m q u e M a d a g a s c a r i a m traiecisse. P o s t q u a m vero sanctis- s i m u s vir, e x t r e m a a e t a t e , in c a e l e s t e m p a t r i a m v o c a t u s est, adeo Congre- g a t i o percrebrescere proferendaeque fidei ardore flagrare perrexit, ut vicariatus apostolicos geratis in praesenti quindecim, clericorum Seminaria c e n t u m m o d e r e m i n i , et nulla fere orbis terrarum pars sit, ubi, domiciliun collocando, v e s t r a e industriae a t q u e actionis q u o d d a m quasi t h e a t r u m n o n c o n s t i t u e n t i s . F o r e n t profecto alia plurima, praeter i s t a q u a e d e l i b a v i m u s , N o b i s in h o n o r e m S o d a l i t a t i s a Missione c o m m e m o r a n d a ; at u n u m q u i d e m silentio praeterire n o n p o s s u m u s , idest n o n p a u c o s e x Vincentianis missio-

nalibus a p o s t o l a t u s m u n u s , q u o d vigiliis, laboribus e t o m n e g e n u s aerum- nis e x s e c u t i essent, s u i d e m u m effusione s a n g u i n i s confecisse a c v e l u t i obsignasse. D u o b u s e x iis, I o a n n i Gabrieli P e r b o y r e e t F r a n c i s c o R e g i s Clet, b e a t o r u m c a e l i t u m honores decretos esse, n e m o ignorat; aliis ut decer- nere q u e a t , A p o s t o l i c a S e d e s o m n i a ordine a u t i a m inquirit aut e s t brevi, s i D e o placuerit, inquisitura. N e c m i n o r e m Congregationi v e s t r a e peperere gloriam c u m I u s t i n u s d e I a c o b i s , qui in A e t h i o p i a a d c a t h o l i c a m f i d e m t r a d u c e n d a i t a d e s u d a v i t q u a m qui m a x i m e , t u m F e l i x d e Andreis, qui Missionem - ut c o n t r a c t a l o q u e n d i r a t i o n e dicere c o n s u e v i s t i s - primus in F o e d e r a t a s A m e r i c a e Civitates i n v e x i t a t q u e mirificos e x c o t i d i a n a operosi a p o s t o l a t u s e x e r c i t a t i o n e fructus percepit. T i b i igitur, dilecte fili, gratula- mur, q u o d S o d a l i t a s i s t a t o t l a u d u m copia, u t a n t e h a c f l o r u i t , sic h o d i e commendetur, et, trium saeculorum spatium D e o dante emensa, nec a n a t i v o spiritu desciverit n e c ullis in q u a e r e n d a h o m i n u m s a l u t e labori- b u s pepercerit; c u p i m u s q u e o m n i b u s Congregationis alumnis, u t e x h a c ter saecularis e v e n t i f a u s t i t a t e s u m a n t a n i m o s a d e a , q u a e in A l t i s s i m i gloriam in q u e a n i m a r u m b o n u m a d h u c egerunt, e t confirmanda stabilius e t uberius m u l t i p l i c a n d a . O m i n i interea v o t o q u e h u i c N o s t r o s u a D o m i - n u s I e s u s gratia f a v e a t a t q u e obsecundet: cuius q u i d e m a u s p i c e m p a t e r - n a e q u e v o l u n t a t i s N o s t r a e t e s t e m , tibi, dilecte fili, u n i v e r s i s q u e a Missione presbyteris a p o s t o l i c a m b e n e d i c t i o n e m p e r a m a n t e r i m p e r t i m u s . D a t u m Romae apud Sanctum Petrum, d i e i v m e n s i s martii a n n o

M D C C C C X X V , Pontificatus N o s t r i quarto.

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